

James Finnie

Product Manager — AI Agents, Fintech & Growth

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PROFILE

Product manager who ships working software. Seven years in regulated fintech — payments, trading, wealth — currently building the AI tooling product teams run on inside one of Canada's largest banks: an agentic product-development platform, an OKF knowledge base for agents, and ML personalization across the full client base. Hands-on with agents, RAG, evals and prototyping, and I build and deploy my own AI products outside work.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Product Manager, AI & Personalization *CIBC Investor's Edge · Toronto* Jul 2025 – Present

- Built an internal Product & Engineering platform where PMs converse with the bank's AI to go from question to artifact: it spins up lightweight working prototypes, pulls context from the corporate second brain and agent skills files, connects to Figma, and drafts PR-FAQs and BRDs — improving handoff of work between product and engineering teams across the bank.
- Mined years of historical engineering estimates against the BRDs that produced them, so the same platform returns evidence-based effort estimates for new proposals.
- Built that second brain on Google's Open Knowledge Format (OKF), Andrej Karpathy's LLM-wiki pattern made concrete: ~4,700 source documents indexed into ~7,600 cross-linked markdown notes (~28,000 references) that agents retrieve by embedding against the chunked question — loading precise context from the corpus rather than overloading the context window with attached files.
- Lead ML personalization for CIBC's direct-investing platform: propensity models score every new client (options, ETFs, FHSA/RRSP) into Braze and Contentstack journeys, with closed-loop retraining lifting accuracy and conversion.
- Replaced BRD-heavy delivery with one- and six-pagers and prototype-first decisions — Claude-built working prototypes pressure-test pricing and packaging concepts in days rather than quarters.

Manager, IoT & Intelligent Systems (Product Owner) *Trudell Medical International · Toronto* Oct 2023 – Jul 2025

- Owned the roadmap for AeroLiv, TMI's first Software-as-a-Medical-Device platform and its connected IoMT respiratory ecosystem; negotiated and ran a \$5M multi-year development contract, delivering compliant with FDA, Health Canada and CE Mark.
- Brought the launch forward a quarter through scope prioritization and QA automation, leading a distributed team of twelve across North America and India.

Associate Product Manager, Global Trading Platforms *StoneX (NASDAQ: SNEX) · London* May 2022 – Jun 2023

- Product manager for the City Index and FOREX.com mobile apps, on platforms carrying roughly half of StoneX Retail's global OTC CFD and spread-bet volume; drove a six-month quality initiative that cut iOS and Android crash rates by 99.58%, lifting retention and trade completion.
- Shipped UX and packaging improvements to SMART Signals, the in-house ML trading-signals product, and ran UAT and A/B cycles on every new mobile build.

Product Analyst, Onboarding *Equals Money (LON: EQLS) · London* Jun 2021 – May 2022

- Rebuilt B2B/B2C onboarding with automated KYC/KYB verification, lifting new-account conversion 35% and cutting approval from weeks to days.

INDEPENDENT PROJECTS — SHIPPED

- **FinanceHermes** · finance-hermes.vercel.app — live financial-research agent with a hand-built harness: streaming tool-call loop over live web search, visible reasoning traces, server-side citation enforcement and a two-tier freemium gate; zero-dependency serverless deploy, demoed live to rooms of investment advisors.
- **Personal OKF knowledge base** — the same LLM-wiki pattern run at home: a cross-linked markdown knowledge graph used as shared context by Claude Code and other agents.
- **The Six Cut** · six-cut.vercel.app — Next.js discovery product ranking Toronto's independent butchers with a proprietary scoring methodology.

EDUCATION

MA, International Studies & Diplomacy (Merit) · SOAS, University of London · 2021 | **MA (SocSci), Business & Management** (2:1) · University of Glasgow · 2020 · Accenture-sponsored Open Banking (PSD2) research

TOOLKIT

AI & Agents	Claude API, Claude Code & agent skills, agent harnesses (tool loops, SSE streaming, evals), RAG / OKF knowledge bases, open models (Hermes 4, Ollama, Mistral)
Growth & Data	Propensity modeling, A/B testing, funnel optimization, Braze, Contentstack, Amplitude, FullStory, Google Analytics
Delivery	Prototype-first, PR-FAQs & six-pagers, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Vercel, Next.js, Scrum